lived, unfortunately."

"What does it feel like to be the first human contact for a baby?"

"I'm not, it's the mother. She's the one who provides everything the child needs through the umbilical cord. I'm just a helper."

"So you don't feel anything?"

"I feel honored and awed. It's magical. But I'm always vigilant. If something goes wrong, then I'm ready." He went quiet. "Sometimes there are seconds in which everything is on the line and making one wrong move will end that new life before it has a chance to take its first breaths. I couldn't live with that on my conscience. So, mostly I'm on guard, expecting the worst so that I'm ready to counter it and save a life."

"I think you're amazing." Léa felt that Josef unlocked the best in her.

"You do?"

"I wish I could help you more."

"You're doing so much. I'm grateful."

"Do you ever worry about how the war will end?"

He half-turned away. "Why worry about what I can't control?"

"To be ready, have a plan, know what you're going to do."

"I'm too busy living in the present." He returned to his notes. "I don't have time to think of the future."

Kiss me, she whispered inside her head. It was a moment of desire so intense and sudden that it nearly overwhelmed her. What was she thinking? Clearly, he wasn't interested. She'd been coming to the sick bay to work with him for nine months and he hadn't tried to kiss her once. Maybe it was seeing Rose and André together in Berlin that made Léa, after denying it to herself for so long, crave love, too. She had to stop. If Josef hadn't kissed her by now, he never would.

She stood. "Let me type a letter for the International Red Cross, requesting deliveries of cod liver oil. The sooner we get them, the better."